NORTHSTAR TECHNOLOGIES PVT. LTD.

Employee Performance Review Policy

Confidential policy governing performance assessment, feedback, review decisions, and employee development

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RESTRICTED – AUTHORIZED ADMINISTRATORS ONLY

This is a fictional demonstration policy created for the Northstar Technologies Pvt. Ltd. OnBoardIQ environment. It is intended for controlled document-ingestion and retrieval testing and is not a legally approved employment policy.

1. Purpose

This policy establishes a consistent, fair, and documented process for reviewing employee performance at Northstar Technologies Pvt. Ltd. It explains review responsibilities, assessment criteria, feedback practices, documentation requirements, and follow-up actions. The process is intended to support employee development, recognize contributions, and help the organization make informed workforce decisions.

- Provide employees with clear expectations and timely feedback.
- Recognize meaningful contributions, strengths, and achievements.
- Identify development needs and agree on practical improvement actions.
- Promote consistency and reduce arbitrary or biased assessment decisions.
- Maintain appropriate confidentiality and controlled access to review records.

2. Scope and Applicability

This policy applies to employees of Northstar Technologies Pvt. Ltd. across departments and job levels. It covers formal performance reviews, interim check-ins, probation reviews, performance improvement plans, and related administrative records.

- HR is responsible for policy administration and process governance.
- Managers are responsible for setting expectations, providing feedback, and conducting reviews.
- Employees are expected to participate, provide relevant self-assessments, and discuss development goals.
- Senior management may review aggregated outcomes and approve decisions within its delegated authority.

Access restriction: This document has access_scope ADMIN_ONLY. Its contents and associated review records are intended only for authorized HR personnel and other explicitly authorized administrators. Employees and managers should receive only the information and forms required for their role through approved channels.

3. Review Cycle and Schedule

The illustrative review framework uses a regular annual cycle supported by quarterly check-ins. HR may publish cycle dates and adjust timelines based on business needs.

Activity	Illustrative timing	Purpose
Goal setting	At the start of the review period	Agree on role expectations, outcomes, and development goals.
Quarterly check-in	Approximately every three months	Discuss progress, feedback, blockers, and support required.
Self-assessment	Before the formal review meeting	Employee summarizes achievements, challenges, and learning.
Manager assessment	During the formal review window	Manager evaluates outcomes and behaviours against agreed expectations.
Calibration and HR review	After manager assessments	Check consistency, evidence quality, and process compliance.
Review discussion	After assessment and calibration	Share feedback, discuss context, and agree on next steps.
Follow-up	Throughout the next review period	Track goals, development actions, and agreed support.

HR will communicate the applicable cycle calendar, submission deadlines, and required templates before each formal review period.

4. Performance Assessment Framework

Performance should be assessed using role-relevant expectations established at the beginning of the review period. Assessments should consider outcomes and the way work is performed, supported by specific examples and evidence.

Dimension	What may be considered
Objectives and results	Progress against agreed goals, delivery quality, timeliness, and measurable outcomes.
Role capability	Technical, functional, and job-specific skills required for the role.
Quality and reliability	Accuracy, attention to detail, consistency, ownership, and follow-through.
Collaboration	Communication, teamwork, knowledge sharing, and constructive participation.
Problem solving	Judgement, initiative, analysis, and ability to resolve issues.
Professional conduct	Respectful behaviour, accountability, integrity, and adherence to company policies.
Learning and growth	Application of feedback, skill development, and progress on agreed learning goals.

The relative importance of each dimension should reflect the employee's role and level. A single universal weighting should not be applied where it would produce misleading comparisons.

5. Rating Guidance

If a rating scale is used, managers should apply the published definitions consistently and provide evidence for the selected rating. The following five-level scale is an illustrative example for the demo environment.

Rating	Label	General interpretation
5	Exceptional	Consistently delivers significantly beyond agreed expectations and demonstrates sustained, high-impact contribution.
4	Exceeds Expectations	Frequently delivers above agreed expectations with strong quality, ownership, and impact.
3	Meets Expectations	Reliably fulfils the core requirements and agreed objectives of the role.
2	Partially Meets Expectations	Meets some requirements but has material gaps that need focused improvement and support.
1	Does Not Meet Expectations	Significant performance gaps remain against essential role expectations and require prompt action.

- A rating must be supported by specific examples, outcomes, and relevant context.
- Managers should not use ratings as a substitute for clear written feedback.
- Where evidence is insufficient, the reviewer should seek clarification rather than assume a rating.
- Ratings should not be based on personal preference, protected characteristics, rumours, or isolated incidents unrelated to role expectations.

6. Employee Self-Assessment

Employees may be asked to submit a self-assessment before the formal review meeting. The self-assessment is an opportunity to provide context and evidence; it is not a requirement to agree with the manager's assessment.

- Summarize progress against agreed objectives and include measurable outcomes where possible.
- Describe significant contributions, challenges, and changes in responsibilities.
- Identify skills developed, training completed, and lessons learned.
- Highlight blockers, dependencies, or support that affected delivery.
- Suggest priorities and development goals for the next review period.

7. Manager Responsibilities and Review Discussion

- Set clear, realistic, and role-relevant objectives with the employee.
- Provide ongoing feedback rather than waiting until the formal review.
- Prepare the assessment using documented outcomes and examples from the review period.

- Consider relevant context, including changes in priorities, available resources, and approved leave.
- Conduct the review discussion respectfully and allow the employee to respond.
- Explain strengths, improvement areas, expectations, and available support.
- Agree on specific follow-up actions, owners, and target dates.

Managers must avoid discriminatory, retaliatory, or inconsistent treatment. Where a manager has a conflict of interest or insufficient direct knowledge, HR should arrange an appropriate alternative reviewer.

8. Calibration and HR Oversight

HR may coordinate a calibration process to promote consistency across teams and reduce the effect of rating inflation, inconsistent standards, or unsupported conclusions. Calibration is not intended to replace evidence-based manager judgement.

- Review whether role expectations and rating definitions were applied consistently.
- Check that significant ratings are supported by relevant evidence.
- Identify potential patterns of bias or inconsistent treatment for further review.
- Confirm that required review steps and approvals have been completed.
- Restrict discussion and access to individuals with a legitimate administrative need.

Any change to a proposed assessment during calibration should be documented with the reason and authorized reviewer.

9. Development Plans and Performance Improvement

Where a review identifies development needs or sustained performance gaps, the manager and employee should agree on practical actions. The response should be proportionate to the issue and appropriate to the employee's role and circumstances.

Plan element	Expected content
Area to develop	Specific skill, behaviour, or outcome requiring improvement.
Expected standard	Clear description of the required performance or observable behaviour.
Actions and support	Training, coaching, mentoring, tools, or other support to be provided.
Measures of progress	Objective milestones or evidence that can demonstrate improvement.
Owner and timeline	Named manager/employee responsibilities and realistic target dates.
Review checkpoints	Scheduled conversations to assess progress and adjust support.

- A formal Performance Improvement Plan (PIP) should be coordinated with HR and communicated clearly to the employee.
- The employee should have a reasonable opportunity to understand expectations and access agreed support.
- Progress and any changes to the plan should be documented.
- Any employment decision connected to performance must follow applicable law, company procedures, and appropriate review.

10. Probation and Role-Change Reviews

- Probation reviews should assess the expectations communicated for the role and the employee's progress during the probation period.
- Managers should provide feedback early enough for the employee to respond to concerns.
- A role change, promotion, transfer, or material change in responsibilities may require revised objectives and a documented transition discussion.
- HR should ensure that review records are correctly associated with the employee, role, department, and relevant review period.

11. Employee Comments and Review Disagreement

Employees should be given an opportunity to provide comments on the review summary and identify factual inaccuracies or areas of disagreement.

- An employee may submit written comments for inclusion with the review record.
- A disagreement should be discussed first with the manager where appropriate.
- If the concern remains unresolved, the employee may raise it with HR through the designated internal process.
- HR may request additional information or an independent review where warranted.
- The existence of a disagreement does not automatically invalidate the review; the employee's response should be retained with the record.

12. Confidentiality, Access Control, and Record Management

Performance review information is confidential employment information and must be handled with care. Access should be limited to authorized personnel with a legitimate business need.

- Store completed reviews in approved HR systems or controlled repositories.
- Apply role-based access controls and audit access to sensitive review records where supported.
- Do not share review details in public channels, informal group chats, or unrelated team documents.
- Use secure channels when transmitting review material and verify recipients before sharing.
- Do not download, copy, or retain review records on unmanaged devices or personal storage.
- Follow the organization's approved retention and secure-disposal schedule and applicable legal requirements.
- Report suspected unauthorized access, disclosure, or loss of review information through the designated incident process.

Document access scope: ADMIN_ONLY. In OnBoardIQ, retrieval of this policy should be restricted to authorized administrators according to the application's RBAC rules. Do not infer that every user with a manager title automatically has access; access must be explicitly granted by the configured authorization policy.

13. Use of Performance Data in Employment Decisions

Performance review information may inform development planning, recognition, compensation review, promotion, role changes, or other workforce decisions where permitted by company policy and applicable law. A review rating alone should not automatically determine an employment outcome.

- Consider the employee's role, responsibilities, review-period context, and documented evidence.
- Apply relevant approval and governance requirements before communicating decisions.
- Keep decision records factual, proportionate, and limited to authorized recipients.
- Do not use performance data for unrelated purposes or make unsupported inferences from incomplete records.

14. Records, Audit, and Policy Compliance

- HR should maintain the official review calendar, templates, process instructions, and completion records.
- Review records should identify the employee, reviewer, review period, submission date, and applicable approvals.
- Changes to finalized records should be traceable, with the reason, date, and authorized person recorded.
- HR may conduct periodic process checks to confirm that reviews are completed and access restrictions are followed.
- Suspected manipulation, unauthorized disclosure, retaliation, or misuse of performance information should be escalated through the appropriate internal process.

15. Roles and Responsibilities

Role	Responsibility
Employee	Participate in review discussions, provide relevant self-assessment information, and work toward agreed development actions.
Manager	Set expectations, provide feedback, assess performance using evidence, and support follow-up actions.
Human Resources	Own the policy, administer review cycles, advise on process, maintain records, and oversee access controls.
Authorized HR Administrator	Manage approved review workflows and records within assigned permissions.
Senior Management	Provide oversight and approve workforce decisions within delegated authority.

16. Exceptions and Policy Review

Exceptions to this policy require documented justification and approval from the designated HR authority. Exceptions involving employee data, confidentiality, or employment decisions should receive appropriate legal, privacy, or senior-management review where necessary.

HR is responsible for reviewing this policy periodically and updating it when business processes, applicable requirements, or company governance practices change. The current approved version should be maintained in the designated policy repository.

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Demo notice: Northstar Technologies Pvt. Ltd. is a fictional company used for demonstration and OnBoardIQ document-ingestion testing. The review schedule, rating scale, and procedures are illustrative and must not be treated as approved legal or employment terms.